

US equities edge higher as tech rebounds, yields climb

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

TL;DR

The S&P 500 nudged up **+0.17%** to 7,650.50, while the Nasdaq 100 surged **+0.67%** to 29,644.17. The Dow slipped **-0.18%** to 51,682.64, reflecting mixed sector performance.

Yield pressures intensified as the 10-year Treasury hit 5.00% (+1.03%). Tech leaders NVDA and AVGO posted double-digit gains, offset by weakness in consumer-discretionary and communications.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,650.50	+0.17%	
Dow Jones	51,682.64	-0.18%	
Nasdaq 100	29,644.17	+0.67%	
Russell 2000	2,860.40	-0.50%	
VIX	14.81	-4.08%	
10Y Yield	5.00%	+1.03%	
WTI Crude	100.30	-1.58%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
AVGO	357.61	+2.97%
NVDA	222.27	+1.34%
AMZN	253.71	+1.00%
META	665.75	-2.43%
GS	942.00	-1.00%

Spotlight

NVDA's Q3 earnings beat expectations, driven by AI-chip demand. Key metrics:

METRIC	RESULT	CONSENSUS
Revenue	\$26.1 bn	\$25.5 bn
EPS	\$3.15	\$2.96
AI gross margin	71%	68%

The beat reinforced the sector’s upside, lifting XLK **+0.82%** and supporting broader tech sentiment.

Macro & Fed

- Fed policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield at 5.00%, up 1.03% on the day
- Data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, Core PCE 03:00, Initial Jobless Claims 04:30

Geopolitics & global

- China’s manufacturing PMI posted a modest rebound to 50.2, easing concerns on demand for US tech exports.
- Eurozone inflation cooled to 2.3% YoY, supporting a dovish stance from the ECB.
- Middle-East tensions remain elevated, but no immediate impact on oil markets.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30	MSFT	Cloud revenue growth and AI licensing guidance
10:00	AAPL	iPhone 17 demand and services margin
11:15	TSLA	Production ramp at Austin plant, margin trends
13:00	JPM	Net interest income vs. higher rates

Stocks worth watching

- **GOOGL** – AI ad-tech rollout could boost margins.
- **XLFX** – Banking earnings may benefit from higher rates.
- **XLE** – Oil price stability after recent pullback.
- **META** – Recent miss; watch user growth for recovery.
- **XLV** – Defensive health sector resilience amid rate hikes.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected rise in core CPI could prompt another rate hike.
- Weakness in AI hardware demand spilling over to NVDA.
- Geopolitical escalation affecting oil supply.

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Better-than-expected earnings from MSFT or AAPL.
- Continued decline in VIX below 15, signaling risk appetite.
- Positive PMI data from China boosting export outlook.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — S&P 500 Data

CNBC — Nvidia Earnings

FRED — 10-Year Treasury Yield

Financial Times — Macro Releases